

Ata Noten Yad

351a

Version 2

Betzalel Shulsinger
Arr. Stuart Izon

Betzalel Shulsinger (also known as Betzalel Odesser) was one of the founding fathers of Eastern European chazzanut, and teacher to nearly every great chazzan of the following generation. Sadly, most of his compositions haven't survived, since he never notated his own music. This setting of Ata Noten Yad is a rare exception, and shows off his range: choral writing, solo chazzanut, and the interplay between the two.

Towards the end of the N'ila Amida, we insert two poignant prayers, Ata Noten Yad and Ata Hivdalta. After five services, the words of Ashamnu and V'al Chet feel very familiar, but here we meet something new. It's a shame how often these words get skipped over, because they carry a real shift in tone: from utter despair to the climax of divine mercy. Ata Noten Yad questions our human worth, closing with a line drawn from King Solomon's reflection on the fleeting nature of humanity in Ecclesiastes 3:19.

Shulsinger's setting mirrors that emotional whiplash. In the middle, a tender, reassuring melody on "But You know" gives way to the appalling image of the next line: "that our end will be with maggots and worms." Then, for the closing section, "For their many works are in vain," Shulsinger reaches for a fughetta, a form prized for its intricate precision. The choice feels deeply ironic, almost a meta-commentary setting the pinnacle of musical craftsmanship against words insisting that all human effort comes to nothing.

Shulsinger spent nearly his entire life in Odessa, but according to several sources, he traveled to the Land of Israel near the end of his life, hoping to spend his final years in Jerusalem. It's recounted that he performed this, his most famous work, for his disciples and friends on the eve of his departure, which, given the subject matter and its bleak ending, must have made for a rather strange send-off.

Andante

Melody Alto

Tenor Bass

6

M
A

T
B

-cha p' - shu - ta l' - ka - bel sha - -

10

M
A

8

-vim l' - ka - bel — sha - vim l' - ka - bel — sha - vim

T
B

15

Recitative

C.

8

mf Va-t'-la-m'-dei-nu a-do-nai e-lo - hei-nu l' - hit - va - dot l' - fa - ne - cha al

M
A

8

fp
Ah

T
B

18

C.

8

kol a-vo-no-tei-nu l' - ma - an nech-dal — mei-o - shek ya - dei - nu

M
A

8

Ah

ya - dei - nu

T
B

22

Adagio

M
A

8

mf
ut-ka - b' - lei - nu bit - shu - va sh' - lei - ma l' - fa - ne - cha

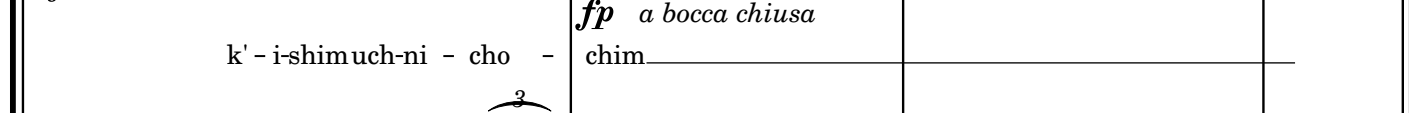
T
B

Recitative

25

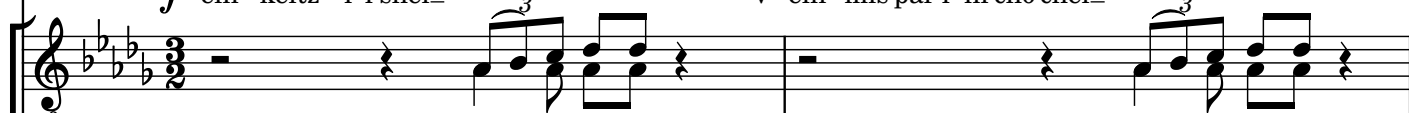
C.  l'-ma - an d'-va - re - cha a-she-_____ a-mar-ta

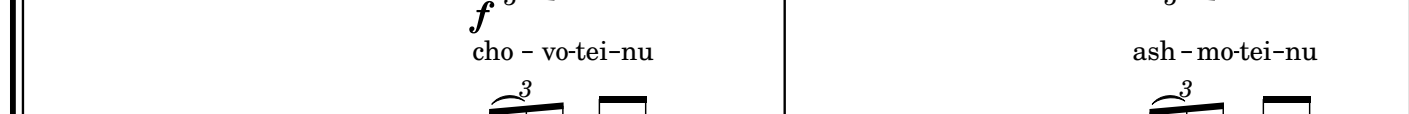
M
A  k' - i-shimuch-ni - cho - *fp* a bocca chiusa chim_____

T
B 

29

C.  *f* ein keitz l'-i-she-_____ v'-ein mis-par l'-ni-cho-chei-_____

M
A  *f* cho - vo-tei-nu _____ ash - mo-tei-nu _____

T
B 

Dolce

31

M
A  *mp* v' - a - ta _____ yo - dei - a v' - a - ta _____ yo -

T
B  v' - a - ta _____ yo - dei - a v' - a -

35

M
A

8

-dei - a v' - a - ta yo - dei - a v' - a - ta yo-dei -

T
B

-ta yo - dei - a yo - dei - a v' - a - ta yo-dei

39

Recitative

C.

8

she-a-cha-ri - tei - nu ri-ma v'-to - lei - a she-a-cha-ri -

M
A

8

- a *p*

T
B

42

C.

8

-tei - nu ri-ma ri - ma ri-ma v' - to - lei - a

M
A

8

T
B

45

Con brio

C.

8

f l' - fi - chach hir-bei - ta s' - li - cha - tei - nu

50

C.

ma — a-nach - nu meh — cha-yei - nu

M
A

f ma a-nach - nu meh cha-yei - nu

T
B

54

C.

meh chas - dei - nu ma tzid³ - ko - tei - nu

M
A

meh chas-dei - nu ma tzid³ - ko - tei - nu

T
B

58

M
A

ma y' - shu - a - tei - nu ma ko - chei - nu

T
B

62

M
A

8

ma g' - vu - ra - tei - nu ma g' - vu - ra -

T
B

66

M
A

8

-tei - nu g' vu - ra - tei - nu

T
B

tei - nu g' - vu - ra - tei - nu

rit.

Andante

C.

8

mf ma no - mar l' - fa - ne - cha a - do -

M
A

8

p Ah a - do -

T
B

75

C.

8

-nai e - lo - hei - nu vei - lo - hei a - vo -

M
A

8

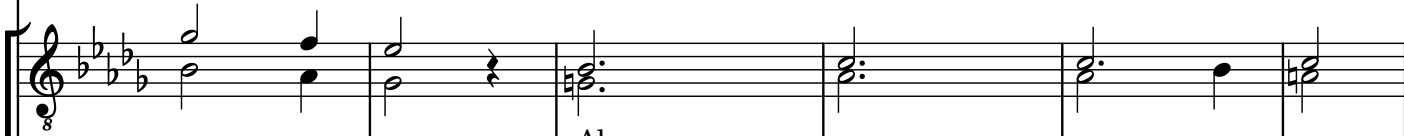
-nai e - lo - hei - nu Ah

T
B

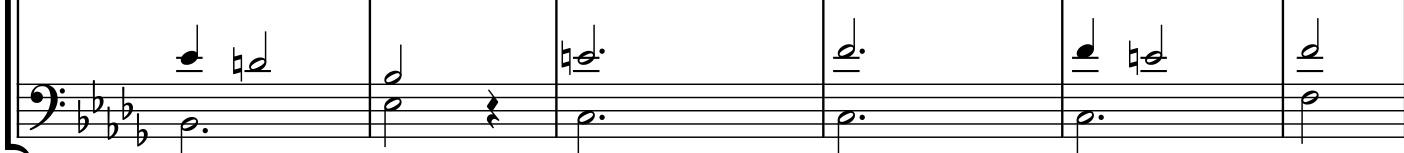
80

C. 

-tei - nu ha - lo kol ha-gi-bo-rim k' - a-yin l - fa - ne - cha

M
A 

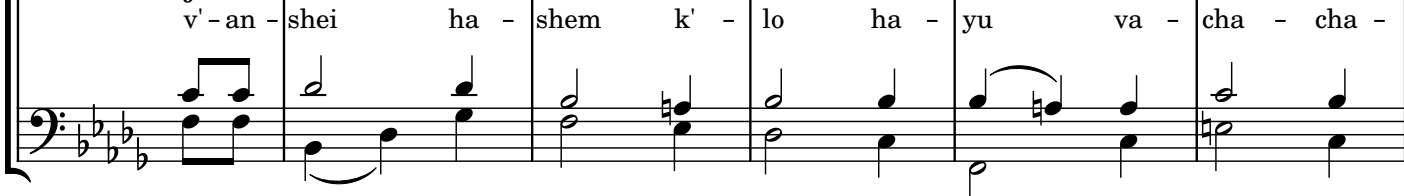
Ah

T
B 

86

M
A 

mf
v' - an - shei ha - shem k' - lo ha - yu va - cha - cha -

T
B 

92

M
A 

-mim kiv - li ma - da un - vo - nim kiv -

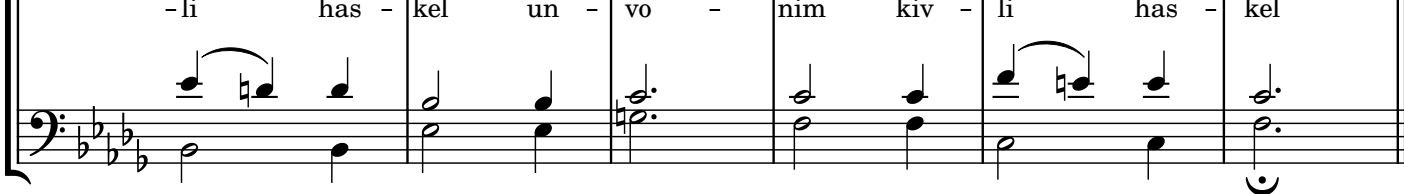
T
B 

97

M
A 

-li has - kel un - vo - nim kiv - li has - kel

rit.

T
B 

Allegretto

Melody *f* Ki rov ma - a-sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

Tenor

Alto

Bass

107

M ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel

T ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

111

M ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei - cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

T ki rov ma - a - sei hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel

A ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

115

M ki rov ma - a - sei - hem ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel

T ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel

A ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

B ki rov ma - a - sei - hem to - hu vi - mei cha - yei - hem he - vel l' - fa - ne - cha

M
8
u - mo - tar ha - a - dam min ha - b' - he - ma_ a - yin ki ha - kol_

T
8
u - mo - tar ha - a - dam min ha - b' - he - ma_ a - yin a - -

A
u - mo - tar ha - a - dam min ha - b' - he - ma_ a - yin ki ha - kol_

B
u - mo - tar ha - a - dam min ha - b' - he - ma_ a - yin a - -

123
C.
8
allarg.
ki ha - kol ha - vel

M
8
ha - vel_ ki ha - kol_ ha - vel_ ki ha - kol ha - vel

T
8
-yin ha - - vel ki ha - kol ha - vel

A
ha - vel_ ki ha - kol_ ha - vel_ ki ha - kol ha - vel

B
-yin ha - - vel ki ha - kol ha - vel